

1 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Pack for a pretend outing

What we are practising

Plan ahead and explain choices using a situation's needs.

What you need

Light bag / Hat / Empty water bottle / Book / Small towel / Large toy

Draw items and circle what to pack.

Before you begin

Choose an imaginary short park visit with an adult on a sunny day.

Use an empty bottle and light bag; an adult chooses real travel, weather and sun protection arrangements.

Try it together

1. Describe the outing and inspect the available items.
2. Choose three items and explain a use for each.
3. Change the outing to an indoor library visit and revise the choices.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which choice changed when our destination changed?

Space to explore

2 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Two builders, one favourite block

What we are practising

State a need, hear another person and propose a workable agreement.

What you need

Two soft toys / One large block

Tell the scene using two drawn characters.

Before you begin

Explain that both characters want the same block for their building.

An adult models supportive language, stays nearby and lets the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Give each character a sentence: "I need this for my roof."
2. Suggest two solutions, such as taking turns or building together.
3. Act out one agreement and check whether both characters can continue.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How can both builders know when a turn ends?

Space to explore

3 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Practise a zip and a button

What we are practising

Follow and describe steps in a self-care task.

What you need

Clean garment with a sturdy zip / Garment with a large securely sewn button

Practise only the fastener available; an adult may hold the fabric.

Before you begin

Lay garments flat and check for loose buttons, damaged teeth or rough edges.

Use intact fasteners; remove any garment with a loose button. Keep skin and hair clear of zips.

Try it together

1. Hold the zip's base steady and move the pull slowly on an already joined zip.
2. For a button, find its matching hole and tilt one edge through first.
3. Take turns describing and trying each step, stopping before frustration grows.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which hand can steady the fabric while the other moves?

Space to explore

4 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Make a clear help request

What we are practising

Describe a problem and make a specific request.

What you need

No materials

Point, gesture or use a picture as part of the request.

Before you begin

Choose an everyday pretend problem, such as a stuck pencil-case zip.

An adult models supportive language, stays nearby and lets the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Model: "My pencil case will not open. Can you help me with the zip?"
2. Let the child practise in their own words or gestures.
3. Try another scenario, such as not understanding an activity instruction, and respond helpfully.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What detail helps the adult understand the problem?

Space to explore

5 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 20 minutes

Plan a family mini-project

What we are practising

Plan an order, agree responsibilities and review a shared result.

What you need

Paper / Pencils / A few books

Plan a shared drawing station instead of a reading corner.

Before you begin

Choose a small project: set up a comfortable floor reading corner.

An adult chooses a clear floor space; children carry only light items and never move furniture or climb shelves.

Try it together

1. Draw three jobs: clear a small space, bring two books, make a welcome sign.
2. Agree who does each job and which should happen first.
3. Complete the jobs, check the list together and change one thing to make the corner easier to use.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which jobs can happen together and which need to wait?

Space to explore

6 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Two helpers and three jobs

What we are practising

Divide several simple jobs between two willing helpers.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw three job symbols and assign them to two fictional helpers.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Two pretend helpers must label pictures, arrange them and tell visitors about them. How could they share three jobs?

Space to explore

7 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Remembering a return day

What we are practising

Create a reminder that links a borrowed item with its return day.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Make a picture reminder for a fictional book return.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A pretend library lends a book until Thursday. What simple reminder could help your character return it on that day?

Space to explore

8 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Choosing between two games

What we are practising

Propose a shared way to choose between two play ideas.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Compare two ways fictional friends could choose one activity.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

One character prefers drawing and another prefers a story. They have time for only one now. What could they agree?

Space to explore

9 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

The missing green pencil

What we are practising

Adapt a plan when one preferred drawing tool is unavailable.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Suggest a workable alternative to an unavailable drawing tool.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Your group planned to draw green trees, but no green pencil is available. What could keep the drawing going?

Space to explore

10 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Check the message chain

What we are practising

Check the accuracy of a message before passing it onward.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Compare two versions of a pretend request and restore a missing detail.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A message says, “Bring two large books,” but a character repeats, “Bring two books.” What detail should be checked?

Space to explore

11 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Say when you will be ready

What we are practising

Communicate when a current turn will end.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Rewrite a vague helping promise using a clear endpoint.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A character says, "I will help soon," while finishing one picture. How could the promise become clearer?

Space to explore

12 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Which drawing belongs to whom?

What we are practising

Use clear labels to distinguish people's similar belongings.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Plan an agreed way to identify two fictional drawings.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Two fictional friends leave similar drawings on a table. How can they tell them apart without guessing?

Space to explore

13 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Tell the change to the team

What we are practising

Tell teammates about a changed plan before they act.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Create a clear message about a changed pretend meeting place.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A pretend art group moves its meeting from the rug to the table. One character has not heard. What should the group explain?

Space to explore

14 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

A request with a reason

What we are practising

Pair a practical request with a reason others can understand.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Say a specific request with a practical reason.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A character wants the shared picture moved away from the table edge. How can it explain its request?

Space to explore

15 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

The unfinished shared picture

What we are practising

Record the next step before pausing a shared picture.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Make a restart note for a fictional unfinished drawing.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Your fictional group stops drawing before the picture is finished. How can it remember what remains next time?

Space to explore

16 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Receiving an idea you did not choose

What we are practising

Ask about a partner's addition before changing shared work.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Respond to a partner's different idea with a question.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A partner adds a pond to a shared garden drawing, but you imagined a path there. What could you ask before changing it?

Space to explore

17 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

A simple handover

What we are practising

Pass useful information to someone taking over a task.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a task in progress and explain it to a new helper.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A puppet starts sorting picture cards, then another takes over. What information will help the second puppet continue?

Space to explore

18 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

A task that fits the time

What we are practising

Compare an estimated task duration with the time available.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Choose a small fictional task that can fit the available time.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A pretend group has eight minutes before a break. A small picture border is expected to take four minutes; a whole booklet, twelve. What could they plan to finish now, and what could wait?

Space to explore

19 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Ask whether your explanation helped

What we are practising

Ask a listener whether an explanation needs more detail.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Act out checking whether a game explanation was clear.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Your character explains a game, but the listener stays quiet. How can the character check understanding without guessing?

Space to explore

20 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

A group choice with one missing voice

What we are practising

Notice whose preference has not yet been heard in a group choice.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Show how a group can invite a quiet character's contribution.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Three characters choose a story. Two speak quickly and the third has not answered. What could make the choice more inclusive?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Pack for a pretend outing

A little hint

Ask what you plan to do and what you might need while doing it.

Answer / what to notice

Several sets can work if choices have sensible uses; the adult remains responsible for real outing preparation.

A useful plan changes when the setting or purpose changes.

Make it easier

Choose between two items for one stated need.

Take it further

Make a picture checklist and check the packed bag against it.

Another day, away from the screen

Help an adult prepare one item for the next real outing.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Two builders, one favourite block

A little hint

Use a clear event, such as finishing one small house, rather than “later”.

Answer / what to notice

A workable agreement is clear and accepted by both; an adult can help if no agreement is possible.

Naming needs and specific next steps gives people something concrete to negotiate.

Make it easier

Choose between two adult-modelled solutions.

Take it further

Show why a vague promise may fail, then improve it.

Another day, away from the screen

Try an agreed turn rule during a shared drawing.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Practise a zip and a button

A little hint

Practise on the table before trying a garment being worn.

Answer / what to notice

Any comfortable method that closes the fastener without force is useful; partial success counts.

Separating a task into stabilising and moving steps makes its parts easier to notice.

Make it easier

An adult starts the movement and the child finishes.

Take it further

Try starting a separating zip with adult help.

Another day, away from the screen

Choose one dressing step to practise when there is no rush.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Make a clear help request

A little hint

Name what happened, then what you need.

Answer / what to notice

A useful request communicates a need; perfect sentences, eye contact or a particular polite phrase are not required.

Specific information helps another person offer suitable help.

Make it easier

Complete “Please help me with...” or point to the problem.

Take it further

Practise clarifying when the adult misunderstands the first request.

Another day, away from the screen

Identify trusted adults the child can approach in familiar settings.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Plan a family mini-project

A little hint

The space should be ready before setting books in it.

Answer / what to notice

Several role arrangements work; a clear order and reachable shared result matter.

A short checklist makes responsibilities and unfinished steps visible.

Make it easier

Use two jobs and complete them side by side.

Take it further

Let the child lead the final check and suggest one improvement.

Another day, away from the screen

Use a picture checklist for another small family project.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

6. Two helpers and three jobs

A little hint

Ask which jobs each helper prefers.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Each takes one job and they share the third, checking that both agree. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Sharing work need not mean the same number of jobs if effort and agreement are considered.

Make it easier

Assign two simple jobs, one each.

Take it further

Revise the plan if one job needs both helpers.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

7. Remembering a return day

A little hint

Include both what returns and when.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: A picture of the book beside Thursday on a calendar can show the return plan. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A reminder connects an action with a visible time cue.

Make it easier

An adult labels Thursday; add the book picture.

Take it further

Add who will help with the pretend return.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

8. Choosing between two games

A little hint

Try combining an idea or taking turns choosing on different occasions.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: They might draw a scene together and tell its story later, if both accept that plan. Other reasoned ideas can work.

An agreement works better when both people understand and accept the choice.

Make it easier

Choose between two adult-modelled agreements.

Take it further

Explain what happens if someone does not accept the first plan.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

9. The missing green pencil

A little hint

Which part matters more: showing a tree or using that exact pencil?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: We could draw tree outlines with another colour and explain the choice. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A missing preferred material does not always stop the main purpose.

Make it easier

Choose another available colour.

Take it further

Invent two alternatives and ask the group which it prefers.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

10. Check the message chain

A little hint

Compare the original words with the repeated ones.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Check “large,” because the number stayed but the size detail disappeared. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Repeating key details helps preserve a message as it passes between people.

Make it easier

Use one book with one size word.

Take it further

Create a new message with a number, object and place.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

11. Say when you will be ready

A little hint

Use an action that the other person can recognise.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: "I can help after I finish this last flower. Is that okay?" Other reasoned ideas can work.

Naming a visible endpoint makes a vague time word easier to understand.

Make it easier

Complete "After I finish..."

Take it further

Offer another plan if the other character needs help now.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

12. Which drawing belongs to whom?

A little hint

Find out first; mark second.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: They can ask each creator and add different agreed symbols to the backs. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Checking ownership before adding a marker avoids making an assumption into a label.

Make it easier

Choose two different picture symbols.

Take it further

Make symbols for three drawings without using real names.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

13. Tell the change to the team

A little hint

Do not assume everyone saw the move.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: "We are drawing at the table now; the place changed from the rug." Other reasoned ideas can work.

A useful update says both the new plan and what changed.

Make it easier

Point to the new place and name it.

Take it further

Ask the listener to explain the new plan back.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

14. A request with a reason

A little hint

Name the desired change and why it helps.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: "Could we move it inward so it is less likely to slide off?" Other reasoned ideas can work.

A brief reason helps others understand the purpose of a request.

Make it easier

Complete "Move it here because..."

Take it further

Consider another way to keep the picture in place.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

15. The unfinished shared picture

A little hint

Choose one clear next step, not only “finish it.”

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: A small note or picture can show “add the bridge” beside the unfinished space. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Recording the next action helps restart a task without reconstructing the whole plan.

Make it easier

Draw one missing feature on a reminder card.

Take it further

Record who agreed to do each of two remaining parts.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

16. Receiving an idea you did not choose

A little hint

Look for a question and a possible connection.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: “What do you like about the pond? Could a path go around it?” Other reasoned ideas can work.

Understanding a contribution can reveal ways to connect ideas instead of removing one.

Make it easier

Ask the partner to explain one feature.

Take it further

Show two layouts that keep both ideas visible.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

17. A simple handover

A little hint

Show one finished example and the remaining pile.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Tell it the sorting rule and which cards are already sorted. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A handover needs the rule and current progress, not only the final goal.

Make it easier

Hand over a task with only two groups.

Take it further

Ask the new helper what still needs explaining.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

18. A task that fits the time

A little hint

Which task is expected to take less than eight minutes?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Finish the small border now and leave the booklet for a longer session. Another plan could work if they reduce the task enough.

Comparing a task estimate with available time helps set a manageable goal; an estimate is not a promise.

Make it easier

An adult draws four marks and twelve marks; compare each with eight marks.

Take it further

Name one way to simplify the booklet into a small task for this session.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

19. Ask whether your explanation helped

A little hint

Offer a comfortable way to respond.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: It can ask, “Would you like to show the first turn, or hear an example?” Other reasoned ideas can work.

Silence alone does not tell us whether someone understood.

Make it easier

Ask if the listener would like one example.

Take it further

Let the listener explain the rule using a drawing.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

20. A group choice with one missing voice

A little hint

Make room without forcing an answer.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Pause and invite the third to speak, point or pass before deciding. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A fair chance to contribute includes different ways to respond and the option to pass.

Make it easier

An adult sketches two story choices; invite the quiet character to point to one.

Take it further

Agree on a speaking order for the next decision.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.